

Change Is a Must: Wrap-Up, Featuring Karen Hilton

Karen Hilton, Founder & President, Executive Coaching

Congratulations you have completed ***Change is a must***. I don't know about you, but I really enjoyed Steve Olson's insights and stories about how Pat Summitt overcame her fears to not only embrace change, but to find innovative ways to inspire others to change, too.

As a senior executive, I agree with Steve that we began the process of change when we decide that we're tired of being "that person," whoever that person might be. And just like Pat Summitt, we've got to really, really like the person we're trying to become.

Some of my key takeaways from Steve's videos are, first, nobody likes change, at least not at first. That's because change is, indeed, scary and uncomfortable. But we can't improve if we don't change. And change that's truly worthy of the effort will help us dramatically improve ourselves again and again and again. To inspire others to change, we must change first. We need to model the way.

Second, as Steve recommends, we have to work like crazy to make sure that the lessons we learn become our new habit and the new habit of everyone on our team and in our company.

Third, change is a force of nature. To change, we must be humble. We have to be humble enough to admit to others and to ourselves that we don't know it all and that we can get better. Pat Summitt never lost that humility. She changed constantly, experimenting with anything and everything that would help her and her teams improve. As Pat's dear friend Coach John Wooden said, "It's what you learn after you know it all that really counts."

As Professor Olson taught us, scientists and change experts know that Pat Summitt was right: change is, indeed, a force of nature. We know now scientifically that people are wired for excellence, and by creating positive relationships and carefully cultivating each person's growth, every organization is capable of achieving excellence.

So, what are you going to change about yourself? Who can help you along the way? Who can you benchmark yourself against in a way that will help you achieve leadership excellence?